

Word family: **dominate / dominates / dominated / dominating / dominant / dominance / predominantly / domination**

Base word: dominate

Past tense: dominated

Past participle: dominated

Related forms: dominating, dominant, dominance, domination

Useful family extensions: dominant position, dominant force, dominate a market, dominate a conversation, dominate the game

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / adjective and noun family (相關形容詞及名詞)

Your sentence:

> “She is not the sort of person who tries to **dominate** a conversation...”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **dominate a conversation** means **to control most of the conversation by speaking too much, directing the topic, or leaving little room for other people to contribute**.

Your grandmother is described as the opposite of this. She does not try to make herself the centre of attention.

繁體中文：**在對話中佔據主導地位，說話過多或控制話題，使其他人較少有機會參與**

中文翻譯：

> “She is not the sort of person who tries to dominate a conversation...”

「她不是那種會試圖**主導整個對話、讓自己佔據大部分發言空間**的人.....」

Here:

dominate a conversation = 控制談話節奏和內容，令自己成為主要發言者，其他人較難參與

1. **dominate + conversation/discussion (對話) — 主導；控制**

This is the exact sense in your passage.

Practice 1 — Original

> “She is not the sort of person who tries to **dominate a conversation**.”

「她不是那種會試圖**主導整個對話**的人。」

Practice 2

> “He tends to **dominate discussions** in meetings.”

「他在會議中往往會**主導討論**。」

Practice 3

> “Try not to **dominate the conversation**.”

「盡量不要**壟斷 / 主導整個談話**。」

dominate a conversation = 在談話中佔據大部分發言空間或控制話題方向

2. **dominate + person/group (支配)** — 支配；控制

A major broader meaning.

Practice 4

> “He tried to **dominate** everyone around him.”

「他試圖**控制 / 支配**身邊每一個人。」

Practice 5

> “She refused to let anyone **dominate** her.”

「她拒絕讓任何人**支配她**。」

dominate someone = 對某人施加強大控制，使對方難以自由作決定或行動

3. **dominate + relationship (關係)** — 在關係中佔主導地位

Practice 6

> “One partner should not **dominate** the relationship.”

「伴侶其中一方不應在關係中**完全佔主導地位**。」

Practice 7

> “He tends to **dominate** group decisions.”

「他往往會在小組決策中**控制主導權**。」

dominate = 在人際關係或共同決策中掌握過多控制權

4. **dominate + market/industry** (市場 / 產業) — 佔據主導地位；支配市場

A very important business sense.

Practice 8

> “A few large companies **dominate** the market.”

「幾間大型公司**主導**這個市場。」

Practice 9

> “The brand has **dominated** the industry for years.”

「這個品牌多年來一直**主導**整個行業。」

dominate a market/industry = 擁有遠高於其他競爭者的市場地位、影響力或份額

5. **dominate + competition/game** (比賽) — 佔盡優勢；控制賽事

Practice 10

> “The home team **dominated** the game.”

「主隊在比賽中**佔盡優勢 / 控制**大部分賽事。」

Practice 11

> “She **dominated** the match from the beginning.”

「她從比賽開始便一直**佔據**明顯優勢。」

dominate a game/match = 在比賽中明顯比對手更強，控制大部分局面

6. **dominate + field/category (領域) — 領先 ; 佔據重要地位**

Practice 12

> “That company **dominates** the smartphone sector.”

「那家公司在智能手機領域**佔據主導地位**。」

Practice 13

> “One style **dominated** fashion during that period.”

「在那個時期，有一種風格**主導了時尚潮流**。」

dominate = 在某個領域、分類或時期中比其他選項更突出、更具影響力

7. **dominate = be the most noticeable feature (視覺 / 空間) — 佔據最顯眼位置 ; 壓過其他元素**

A useful spatial/visual sense.

Practice 14

> “A large tower **dominates** the skyline.”

「一座高塔**主導整個天際線 / 非常顯眼**。」

Practice 15

> “The mountain **dominates** the landscape.”

「那座山在整個景觀中**非常突出、佔據視覺主導位置**。」

dominate a view/landscape = 因體積、位置或視覺效果而成為最突出的元素

8. **dominate = occupy most of something (佔據大部分) — 佔據 ; 充斥**

Practice 16

> “Work **dominated** his life.”

「工作**佔據了他生活的大部分**。」

Practice 17

> “The issue **dominated** the news for several days.”

「這個議題幾天內一直**佔據新聞主要篇幅**。」

dominate = 某件事佔用大部分時間、注意力、空間或內容

9. **dominate + thoughts/attention (思想 / 注意力) — 佔據 ; 控制**

Practice 18

> “The problem **dominated** her thoughts.”

「這個問題一直**佔據她的思緒**。」

Practice 19

> “One concern **dominated** the meeting.”

「一個問題**主導了整場會議的注意力**。」

dominate = 某個想法或問題持續佔據主要注意力，令其他事情難以被重視

10. **dominate + politics/debate/media coverage (議題 / 公共討論) — 主導 ; 成為主要焦點**

Practice 20

> “The economy **dominated** the debate.”

「經濟議題**主導了整場辯論**。」

Practice 21

> “The story **dominated** media coverage.”

「這則新聞**佔據了媒體報道的主要焦點**。」

dominate = 成為某場討論、媒體內容或公共議題中最主要的焦點

11. **dominating** = controlling / overpowering (強勢支配的) — 支配性的 ; 壓迫性的

A related adjective/participle use.

Practice 22

> “He has a very **dominating** personality.”

「他的性格非常**強勢、喜歡控制別人**。」

Practice 23

> “Her **dominating** behaviour made others uncomfortable.”

「她那種**強勢支配別人**的行為**令其他人感到不舒服**。」

dominating = 經常試圖控制別人、局面或決定的

This often has a negative tone.

12. **dominant** = having the most power/influence (主導的) — 佔主導地位的 ; 最有影響力的

The main adjective form.

Practice 24

> “The company has a **dominant** position in the market.”

「這家公司在市場中佔有**主導地位**。」

Practice 25

> “She became the **dominant** player in the match.”

「她成為比賽中**最佔優勢的選手**。」

dominant = 在權力、影響力、地位或表現上明顯超過其他人 / 事物

13. **dominant** = most noticeable / important (最突出) — 最主要的 ; 最顯著的

Practice 26

> “Blue is the **dominant colour** in the painting.”

「藍色是這幅畫中**最主要 / 最突出的顏色**。」

Practice 27

> “Fear was the **dominant emotion**.”

「恐懼是當時**最強烈、最主要的情緒**。」

dominant = 在一組元素中最突出、最強或最重要的

14. **dominant trait/gene** (生物 / 遺傳) — 顯性的

A common scientific meaning.

Practice 28

> “Brown eyes may result from a **dominant gene**.”

「棕色眼睛可能與**顯性基因**有關。」

Practice 29

> “The **dominant trait** appears when only one copy of the gene is present.”

「只要存在一份相關基因，**顯性特徵**便可能表現出來。」

dominant — genetics = 即使只有一份相關基因，也能在表型中表現出來的

This is a genuine domain-specific meaning.

15. **dominance** = control / superiority (支配地位) — 主導地位；優勢

The main noun form.

Practice 30

> “The company’s market **dominance** continued.”

「這家公司在市場中的**主導地位**持續存在。」

Practice 31

> “The team showed complete **dominance**.”

「球隊展現出完全的**壓倒性優勢**。」

****dominance = 在權力、控制、影響力或競爭表現上高於其他人的狀態****

16. ****dominance = social/behavioural control (支配性) — 支配；強勢控制****

Practice 32

> “The study looked at patterns of social **dominance**.”

「研究探討了社會中的**支配關係 / 權力優勢模式**。」

Practice 33

> “His need for **dominance** affected the relationship.”

「他強烈的**控制欲 / 支配需求**影響了這段關係。」

****dominance = 在人際或群體關係中取得較高控制權或地位****

17. ****domination = complete/strong control (控制 / 支配) — 支配；控制；統治****

A related noun, usually stronger than ****dominance****.

Practice 34

> “The team’s total ****domination**** surprised everyone.”

「球隊的全面**壓制 / 支配表現**令所有人驚訝。」

Practice 35

> “The story is about political ****domination****.”

「這個故事涉及政治上的**控制 / 支配**。」

****domination = 對某人、群體、領域或局面施加強而持續的控制****

18. ****dominant hand (慣用手) — 慣用手****

A useful established compound.

Practice 36

> “Her right hand is her ****dominant hand****.”

「她的右手是她的****慣用手****。」

Practice 37

> “Try the exercise with your non-dominant hand.”

「嘗試用你的****非慣用手****做這項練習。」

****dominant hand = 日常活動中較常使用、控制力通常較好的那隻手****

This develops from “more powerful/controlling.”

19. ****dominant language/culture (主要語言 / 文化) — 主流的；佔主導地位的****

Practice 38

> “English is the ****dominant language**** in the workplace.”

「英語是這個工作環境中的****主要語言****。」

Practice 39

> “The ****dominant culture**** strongly influenced the media.”

「****主流文化****對媒體產生了很大影響。」

****dominant = 在社會、文化或語言環境中影響力 / 使用程度最大****

20. ****dominant position (優勢位置) — 主導地位；優勢地位****

Practice 40

> “The company holds a **dominant position** in the industry.”

「這家公司在行業中處於**主導地位**。」

Practice 41

> “The team moved into a **dominant position** early in the match.”

「球隊在比賽初段便取得了**明顯優勢**。」

dominant position = 相比其他競爭者擁有更高權力、影響力或優勢的位置

Important distinction: dominate vs control

control

is broad and neutral:

> have power over how something operates or happens.

dominate

usually means:

> have **much more** control, power, influence, presence, or strength than others.

> “She controlled the meeting.”

= 她控制會議進行。

> “She dominated the meeting.”

= 她幾乎主導了整場會議，其他人的空間很少。

So **dominate** is stronger.

Important distinction: dominate vs lead

lead

can mean guiding others and is often positive or neutral.

dominate

means holding much more power/control than others and can easily sound negative.

> “She led the discussion.”

= 她帶領討論。

> “She dominated the discussion.”

= 她主導得太多，其他人較難參與。

This distinction is central to your passage.

Important distinction: **dominate vs influence**

influence

= affect someone's thinking or what happens.

dominate

= have such strong influence/control that other influences become secondary.

So:

influence < dominate in strength.

Important distinction: **dominate a conversation vs lead a conversation**

lead a conversation

can simply mean:

> guide the topic or facilitate discussion.

dominate a conversation

means:

> take up too much space, control the direction, or prevent balanced participation.

Your sentence deliberately uses **dominate**, not **lead**, because the writer is describing a behaviour the grandmother **does not** have.

Important distinction: **dominate vs **monopolize****

**monopolize a conversation**

means:

> take nearly all the speaking time for yourself.

**dominate a conversation**

is broader:

> speak too much, control topics, interrupt, or exercise disproportionate influence.

They overlap strongly, but **monopolize** focuses more specifically on taking almost all of a shared resource/time.

Important distinction: **dominate vs **overpower****

**dominate**

can describe:

- * people
- * markets
- * sport
- * discussions
- * visual scenes
- * media attention

**overpower**

more often means:

- * physically defeat/control
- * overwhelm the senses or emotions

> “The smell overpowered the room.”

So **dominate** has a broader structural “main force” sense.

Important distinction: **dominating** vs **dominant**

These are easy to confuse.

dominating

often describes **behaviour that actively controls other people**.

> “a dominating personality”

= 強勢、愛控制別人的性格

Often negative.

dominant

describes being **most powerful, influential, important, or prominent**.

> “the dominant company”

= 市場主導公司

It does not necessarily imply inappropriate behaviour.

Important distinction: **dominant** vs **main**

main

= most important or central.

dominant

= strongest, most powerful, most influential, or most noticeable.

> “the main topic”

= 主要話題

> “the dominant topic”

= 佔據討論、壓過其他話題的議題

So **dominant** is stronger.

Important distinction: **dominance vs domination**

dominance

usually describes the **state or position** of being dominant.

> “market dominance”

= 市場主導地位

domination

often emphasizes the **act/process or very strong condition of controlling/overwhelming others**.

> “total domination”

= 全面壓制 / 支配

Domination often sounds stronger and more negative.

Important distinction: **dominant — general vs genetics**

General:

> “the dominant company”

= 最有影響力 / 主導市場的公司

Genetics:

> “a dominant gene”

= 顯性基因

The scientific meaning is specialized and should be learned separately.

Family-extension note

Following the reference curation style, these are especially useful members and constructions of the ****dominate**** family:

- * ****dominate a conversation**** = 主導 / 壟斷談話
- * ****dominate someone/group**** = 支配 / 控制
- * ****dominate a relationship**** = 在關係中過度佔主導
- * ****dominate a market/industry**** = 主導市場 / 行業
- * ****dominate a game/match**** = 佔盡優勢
- * ****dominate a field**** = 在某領域佔據主要地位
- * ****dominate a landscape/view**** = 成為最顯眼的元素
- * ****dominate someone's life/thoughts**** = 佔據生活 / 思緒的大部分
- * ****dominate a debate/news cycle**** = 成為主要焦點
- * ****dominating personality**** = 強勢、愛控制別人的性格
- * ****dominant**** = 佔主導 / 最突出 / 最有影響力的
- * ****dominant gene/trait**** = 顯性基因 / 特徵
- * ****dominance**** = 主導地位 / 優勢
- * ****domination**** = 強勢支配 / 全面控制
- * ****dominant hand**** = 慣用手
- * ****dominant language/culture**** = 主流語言 / 文化
- * ****dominant position**** = 主導 / 優勢地位

As in the curation reference, these include core lexical senses, figurative applications, domain-specific meanings, collocations, and useful family derivatives. They should be grouped where the underlying concept remains ****disproportionately greater control, influence, prominence, or power****, rather than artificially splitting every context.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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dominate a conversation	在談話中佔據大部分發言空間或控制話題，使其他人較難參與
dominate a person/group	對某人 / 群體施加很強控制，使對方難以自由決定或行動
dominate a relationship	在關係或共同決策中掌握過多控制權
dominate a market/industry	在市場份額、影響力或競爭地位上明顯超越其他競爭者
dominate a game/match	在比賽中明顯比對手更強並控制大部分局面
dominate a field	在某個領域中佔據最重要或最具影響力的位置
dominate a landscape/view	因體積、位置或視覺效果而成為最突出元素

dominate someone's life/thoughts	佔據某人大部分時間、注意力或思緒	
dominate debate/media	成為某場討論 / 媒體內容的主要焦點	
dominating	經常主動控制別人、局面或決定；通常帶負面意味	
dominant — power/influence	在權力、影響力、地位或表現上明顯超過其他人 / 事物	
dominant — noticeable	在一組元素中最突出、最強或最重要的	
dominant — genetics	即使只有一份相關基因也能在表型中表現出來的；顯性的	
dominance — competitive/power	在權力、影響力或競爭表現上高於其他人的狀態	
dominance — social	在人際 / 群體關係中取得較高控制權或地位	
domination	對某人、群體、領域或局面施加強而持續的控制	
dominant hand	日常活動中較常使用、控制力較好的那隻手	
dominant language/culture	在某社會環境中使用程度或影響力最大的語言 / 文化	
dominant position	相比其他人 / 競爭者擁有明顯較高權力、影響力或優勢的位置	

For your original sentence

> “She is not the sort of person who tries to ****dominate a conversation****, but when she does speak, people listen.”

The exact meaning is:

****dominate = 在談話中取得過多控制權，說話過多或主導話題，使其他人較少有參與空間****

Therefore:

> ****dominate a conversation****

= ****「主導 / 壟斷談話，令自己佔據大部分發言和注意力」****

The second half of the sentence creates an important contrast:

> she does ****not**** dominate conversations

but:

> when she does speak, people listen.

So her influence comes from ****the value and wisdom of what she says****, not from speaking the loudest or longest.

That is exactly why ****dominate**** is stronger and more negative here than:

> ****lead a conversation****

> = 帶領對話

or:

> ****participate in a conversation****

> = 參與對話.